



51. Kathopanishat Kpshṇa Yajur Vedeeya Mahā Vedāntopanishat

Harīh Omn

Saha nāṁ avatu |
Saha now bhunaktu |
Saha veeryamṇ karavāvahi |
Tejasvināvadheetam astu |
Mā vidvishāvahi ||

Omn śāntih śāntih śāntih

Prathamā vallee

1. Om uśān ha vai
Vājaśravasah sarva-vedasan dadow
Tasya ha Nachiketā nāma putra āsa ||
2. Tamn ha kumāramṇ santamṇ
dakṣiṇāsu neeyamānā
śraddh-āviveśa so'manyata ||
3. Peetodakā jagdha tṛṇā
Dugdha dohā nirindriyā |
Ānanda nāma te lokās
Tān sa gacchata tā dadat ||
4. Sa hovācha pitaramṇ tāta
Kasmai māṁn dāsyateeti |
Dviteeyamṇ tṛteeyamṇ tamn hovācha
Mptyave tvā dadāmeeti ||
5. Bāhoonām emi prathamō
Bāhoonām emi madhyamah |
Kimn svid Yamasya kartavyamṇ
Yan mayādya karishyati ||



51. Katha Upanishat A Major Vedānta Upanishat From Krishna Yajur Veda

Hail Hari

May He protect us both,
May He guide us both,
May we both strive hard,
May our study be invigorating,
May we never hate each other.

Omn Peace Peace Peace

The First Branch

1. Desirous of heaven,
Vājaśravas was giving away all his
possessions in a ritual he was
performing.
He had a son named Nachiketa.
2. Watching the ritual,
Nachiketa, who was still a boy,
Became faithful and wondered within
himself:
3. What kind of heaven known as the
blissful world would a man gain,
If he sacrificed old and barren cows?
4. Nachiketa said:
O Father, to whom would you give me?
He asked him a second and a third time.
Thereupon the father said: unto Death.
5. I may be the best or the middling
Among many of my father's offerings,
What is it my father would gain
By offering me today to Death?

6. Anupaśya yathā poorve
Pratipaśya tathāpare |
Sasyam iva martyah pachyate
Sasyam iva jāyate punah ||

7. Vaiśvānarah praviśaty-
Atithir Brāhmaṇo gṛhaṇ |
Tasya tān śāntim kurvanti
Hara vaivasvatodakam ||

8. Āśā prateekshe sangatam soonptam
Cheshtā poorte putra pašoonś cha
sarvaṇ
Etat vṛṇkte purushasyālpa medhaso
Yasyānaśnan vasati brāhmaṇo gphe ||

9. Tisro rātreer yaḍ avatseer gphe
Me'naśnan brahman atithir namasyah |
Namas te'stu brahman svasti me'stu
Tasmāt prati treen varāṇ vṛṇeesva ||

10. Śānta sankalpah sumanā yathā syāḍ
Veeta-manyur Gowtamo mābhi Mṛtyo |
Tvat praspśhtam mābhivadet prateeta
Etat trayāṇamṇ prathamam varam
vṛṇe ||

11. Yathā purastat bhavitā prateeta
Ouddālakir Āruṇir mat praspśhtah |
Sukhamṇ rātreeś śayitā veetamanyus
tvam
Dadṣivāṇ Mṛtyu mukhāt pramuktam ||

12. Svarge loke na bhayamṇ kiṇ cha
nāsti

6. Think of all those that have gone
before,
And of all those that will go henceforth,
Like corn a man ripens and falls,
And like corn a man springs up again.

7. The attendants of Yama, the God of
Death, said to themselves:
For a Brahman to enter a house as a guest
Is as Vaiśvānara, the fire, entering the
house.
O Vaivasvata, bring us some water
That would pacify the Brahman guest.

8. For a Brahman to dwell in the house
Without proper reception and feeding,
Would mean to the householder
The loss of all his possessions,
The rewards of all his sacred and secular
acts, his sons and all his cattle.

9. Yama, the God of Death said:
O Brahman, O Venerable Guest,
Salutations to you and welfare to me.
You have spent three nights in my house
Without eating and drinking,
Ask of me, therefore, three boons,
One for each day.

10. Nachiketa said:
O Yama, as the first of the three boons,
I choose that Gowtama, my father,
Be peaceful, kind, and well-disposed,
And he may recognize me
and welcome me when I shall have been
dismissed by you.

11. Yama said:
O Nachiketa, surely by my grace,
That Uddālaka Aruni, your father,
Will recognize you and love you as
heretofore.
Seeing you alive again,
He would sleep in great comfort.

12. Nachiketa said:
In heaven there is no fear at all,

Na tatra tvamn na jarayā bibheti |
Ubhe'teertva āśanāya pipāse
Śokātigo modate svarga loka ||

Nor death, nor quivering from old age.
Free from thirst and hunger,
Far away from sorrow,
All rejoice in heaven.

13. Sa tvam agnim svargyam adhyeshi
Mptyo
Prabroohi tam śraddhadhānāya
mahyam |
Svarga loka amptatvamn bhajanta
Etat dviteeyena varamn vṛṇe vareṇa ||

13. O Yama, you know that ritual,
Which leads us to heaven and
immortality.
Teach me that ritual as my second boon,
For I am full of faith and zeal.

14. Pra te braveemi tad u me nibodha
Svargyam agnin Nachiketah prajānan |
Ananta lokāptim atho pratishṭhamn
Viddhi tvam etan nihitamn guhāyam ||

14. Yama said:
Learn from me, O Nachiketa,
I shall teach you that fire ritual,
Which leads the performers to heaven.
Know that it is the attainment of the
endless worlds, that are lodged in the
secret cave.

15. Lokādim agnim tam uvācha tasmai
Yā ishtah kṛ yāvateer yathā vā |
Sa chāpi tat pratya vadat yathoktam
Athāsyā Mptyuh punar evāha tushtah ||

15. Then Yama taught him the fire
ritual,
The beginning of the worlds,
The number of bricks and the
construction of the altar.
Nachiketa repeated it all as it had been
told.
Yama, being pleased with him said
again:

16. Tam abraveet preeyamāṇo mahātmā
Varamn tavehādyā dadāmi bhooyah |
Tavaiva nāmna bhavitāyam agnih
Spṅkhamn chemam aneka roopamn
gphāṇa ||

16. Being pleased, O Great Self,
I grant you another boon.
The fire ritual shall henceforth be known
As Nachiketa fire ritual.
Take also this chain of many forms.

17. Triṇāchiketas tribhir etya sandhimn
Trikarma-kṛt tarati janma mptyoo |
Brahma jajñamn devam eēḍyam viditva
Nichāyye'māmn vṛantim atyantam eti ||

17. Whoever lights up the three
Nachiketa fires
And makes the three sacrifices,
And whoever performs the three duties,
Overcomes birth and death.
Knowing that all this comes from
Brahman, the God, the Adorable Lord,
One attains perfect peace.

18. Triṇāchikteas trayam etad viditva
Ya evamn vidvānś chinute Nāchiketam |

18. Whoever knows the three
Nāchiketa fires,

Mptyu paśān purataḥ praṇodya
Śokātigo modate svarge loka ||

And knowing kindles the three fires,
Throwing off the chains of death,
Rejoices in heaven beyond
the reach of grief.

19. Esha te'gnir Nachiketah svargyo
Yam avṛṇeetaḥ dviteeyena vareṇa |
Etaṁ agnimn tavaiva pravakshyanti
janāśas
Tṛpteeyamn varamn Nachiketo
vṛṇeeshva ||

19. This is your fire, O Nachiketa,
That leads to heaven,
This is your second gift,
All men will call it the Nachiketa Fire.
Choose now your third boon.

20. Yeyam prete vichikitsa manushye'
steety eke nāyam asteeti chaika |
Etaṁ vidyaṁ anuśishṭas tvayāhamn
Varāṇāṁ esha varas tṛpteeyah ||

20. Nachiketa said:
There is a doubt regarding this.
Some say that a man continues to exist
after death,
Others say that he does not.
I should like to be taught by you.
Clear this doubt as my third boon.

21. Devair atṛṇpi vichikitsitamn purā
Na hi suvijñeyam aṇur esha dharmah |
Anyamn varamn Nachiketo vṛṇeeshva
Mā moparotseer ati mā spjainam ||

21. Yama said:
Even the gods are not clear on this point,
Subtle indeed is this point,
Hard indeed it is to grasp,
Choose another boon, O Nachiketa,
Do not press me for this boon.

22. Devair atṛṇpi vichikitsitamn kila
Tvañ cha Mptyo yan na suvijñeyam
āttha |
Vaktā chāsya tvādpṛg anyo na labhyah
Nānyo varas tulya etasya kaśchit ||

22. Nachiketa said:
Hard, you say, is this to comprehend,
When even the gods also do not know
this point,
O Yama, where can I meet a teacher of
your rank?
What other boon compares with this?

23. Śatāyusha putra powtrān vṛṇeeshva
Bahoon paśoon hasti hiraṇyam aśvān |
Bhoomer mahad āyatanamn vṛṇeeshva
Svayañ cha jeeva śarado yāvad icchasi ||

23. Yama said:
Ask for sons and grandsons,
Who shall live a hundred years,
Ask for cattle, elephants, horses, and
gold,
Ask for a great abode on earth,
And ask to live as long as you desire.

24. Etad tulyamn yadi manyase varamn
vṛṇeeshva vittamn chira jeevikañ cha |
Mahā bhoomow Nachiketas tvam edhi
Kāmānāmn tvā kama bhājamn karomi

24. Choose anything that is equal to that,
Choose wealth, choose long life,
Choose an empire, O Nachiketa,
I shall make you an enjoyer of your

||

25. Ye ye kama durlabha martya loka
Sarvan kamāñś chandatah
prarthayasva |
Ima ramah sarathah satooryah
Na heedṣa lambhaneeya manushyaih |
Abhir mat prattabhiih paricharayasva
Nachiketo maraṇam manupraksheh ||

26. Śvobhava martyasya yad antakaitat
Sarvendriyaṇam jarayanti tejah |
Api sarvam jeevitam alpam eva
Tavaiva vahas tava nṛtya geete ||

27. Na vittena tarpaneeyo manushyah
Lapsyamahe vittam adrakshma chet tvā
|
Jeevishyamo yavad eēishyasi
Varas tu me varaneeya sa eva ||

28. Ajeeryatam amṛtanam upetya
Jeeryan martyah kvadasthah prajanan |
Abhidhyayan varṇa rati pramodan
Atideerghe jeevite ko rameta ||

29. Yasminn idam vichikitsanti Mṛtyo
Yat saṃparāye mahati broohi nas tat |
Yo'yam varo goodham anupravishṭo
Nanyam tasmā Nachiketa vṛṇeete ||

Dviteeya Vallee

1. Anyach chreya anyad utaiva preyaste
Ubhe nanarthe purusham sineetah |
Tayoh śreya ādadānasya sādhu bhavati
Heeyate'rthad ya u preyo vṛṇeete ||

dreams.

25. Choose pleasures beyond human
reach,
Choose to be served by fair maidens,
With their chariots and their orchestra,
But do not ask what lies beyond death.

26. Nachiketa said:
But these are things, O Yama, that do not
last long,
The sensual pleasures wear away the
organs, and make life short and
dispirited,
Keep chariots, dances, and music
all for yourself.

27. Who will be happy with wealth?
Will wealth follow us when we face
death?
Will we live for more than you ordain us
to? I cannot ask for any other boon.

28. What man subject to death and
decay,
Getting the chance to become immortal,
Would delight in a long life,
Thinking of sensual pleasures?

29. O Yama: Clear this doubt,
Whether there is a great Hereafter or not,
For Nachiketa would not consider
anything as mysterious as this.

The Second Branch

1. Yama said:
The good is one thing, the pleasant
another,
Both bind the soul in different ways;
It is better to follow the good and attain
sanctity than to follow the pleasant and
miss the end.

2. Šreyaś cha preyaś cha manushyam
Etas tow sampareetya vivinakti dheerah |
Šreya hi dheero'bhipreyaso vṛṇeete
Preya mando yoga kshemād vṛṇeete ||

3. Sa tvamn priyaṁ priya roopāñś cha
kāmaṁ
Abhidhyāyan Nachiketo tyasrākśheeh |
Naitāmn spṅkamn vittamayeem avāpto
Yasyāmn majjanti bhāvo manushyāh ||

4. Dooram ete vipareete vishoochee
Avidyā yā cha vidyeti jñāta |
Vidyābheepsinamn Nachiketasam
manyē
Na tvā kāma bahavo loloupantah ||

5. Avidyāyam antare vartamānāh
Svayamn dheerāh paṇḍitamn
manyamānāh |
Dandramyamānāh pariyanti mooḍhā
Andhenaiva neeyamānā yathāndhāh ||

6. Na sāmparāyah pratibhāti bālamn
Pramādyantamn vitta mohena mooḍham
|
Ayam loko nāsti para iti mānee
Punar vaśam āpadyate me ||

7. Šraṇāyāpi bahubhir yo na labhyah
Šṛṇvanto'pi bahavo yamn na vidyuh |
Āścharyo vaktā kuśalo'sya labdhā
Āścharo jñāta kuśalānuśishṭah ||

8. Na nareṇāvareṇa proktā esha
Suvijñeyo bahudhā chintyamānah |
Ananya prokte gatir atra nāsty-

2. When a man has a choice
Between the good and pleasant,
The wise prefer the good,
But the fools choose the pleasant
Through greed and avarice.

3. O Nachiketa, after pondering
over the pleasant,
You have let them go;
Tangled in the noose of wealth
Many fools have lost their heads.

4. Divergent and apart are these two,
Ignorance and what is known
as knowledge;
O Nachiketa, I think you are
for knowledge,
For even countless desires did not
tempt you away.

5. Dwelling in the midst of ignorance,
Wise in their own estimation,
Bragging of their wisdom,
Treading on a tortuous path,
These fools go round and round
Like blind men led by the blind.

6. To these fools, lost
in the delusion of wealth,
There is no hereafter nor any other
world,
And this world alone is real;
They come again and again under
my sway.

7. Many do not hear of the Self;
Some hear but do not comprehend Him;
Marvelous is he who comprehends,
and expounds the Self;
Marvelous is he who comprehends the
Self when taught by an able teacher.

8. The Self is not well-comprehended
When taught by an inferior teacher,
Who thinks of the Self as manifold;

Anēeyan hy-atarkyam anupramāṇat ||

There is no end to such a discussion
Until one is taught that
The Self indeed is smaller than the
smallest.

9. Naishā tarkenā matir āpaneyā
Proktānyenaiva sujñānāya preshta |
Yam tvam āpah satya dhṛtir batāsi
Tvāḍṛṇ no bhooyan Nachiketaḥ
prashṭa ||

9. This is not understood by logic;
It is known only through proper teaching;
Blessed indeed are you, O Nachiketa,
For you are steadfast in truth;
May we always have an inquirer like
you.

10. Jānāmy-aham śevadhir ity-anityam
Na hi adhruvaih prāpyate hi dhruvam
tat |
Tato mayā Nachiketaś chito'gnir
Anityair dravyaih prāptavan asmi
nityam ||

10. Knowing that the eternal is not
attained
Through the pursuit of transient
pleasures,
I myself sacrifice the transient pleasures
In the Nāchiketa fire and attain the
eternal.

11. Kāmasyāptim jagataḥ
pratishṭhām
Krator anantyaṁ abhayasya param |
Stoma mahad urugāyam pratishṭhām
Dṛshṭvā dṛshṭvā dheero Nachiketo'
tyasrāksheḥ ||

11. The fulfillment of desires
Which is the foundation of this world,
The shore of fearlessness
Attained through endless rituals,
The foundation of all magical powers,
All these are within your reach,
But O Nachiketa, seeing and seeing,
And being wise, you have rejected
them all.

12. Tamn durdarśam gōḍham
anupraviṣṭam
Guhāhitam gahvareshṭam purāṇam |
Adhyātma yogaḍhi-gamena devam
matvā dheero harsha śokow jahāti ||

12. Through meditation,
The wise see deep within their hearts,
The Ancient Self, the God,
Who is hard to be comprehended,
And pass beyond sorrow and joy.

13. Etach chrutvā samparigṛhya martyaḥ
Pravṛshya dharmyaṁ aṇum etam āpya |
Sa modate modanēyam hi labdhvā
Vivṛtam sadma Nachiketasam manye ||

13. Hearing about Him,
comprehending Him well,
The mortal, seizing the subtle essence of
all, rejoices at the very cause of rejoicing.
O Nachiketa, I think the gates of joy
are open to you.

14. Anyatra dharmād anyatrādharmād
Anyatrasmat kṛtākṛtāt |
Anyatra bahootach cha bhavyach cha

14. Nachiketa said: O Yama, tell me
Which is neither the truth nor the
untruth?

Yat tat paśyati tad vada ||

15. Sarve vedā yat padam āmananti
Tapānsi sarvaṇi cha yad vadanti |
Yad icchanto brahmacharyam charanti
Tat te padam sangraheṇa braveemi ||
Om ity-etat ||

16. Etadd hi evāksharam Brahman
Etadd hi evāksharam param |
Etadd hi evāksharam jñātvā
Yo yad icchati tasya tat ||

17. Etad ālambanam śreṣṭham
Etad ālambanam param |
Etad ālambanam jñātvā
Brahma loka maheeyate ||

18. Na jāyate mriyate vā vipaśchin
Nāyam kutaśchin na
bahoova kaśchit |
Ajo nitya śāśvato'yaṁ purāṇo
Na hanyate hanyamāne śareere ||

19. Hanta chen manyate hantum
Hataś chen manyate hatam |
Ubho tow vijāneeto
Nāyam hanti na hanyate ||

20. Aṇor aṇeeyā mahato maheeyā
Ātmasya jantor nihito guhāyam |
Tam akraṭuh paśyati veeta-śoko
Dhātu prasādan mahimānam ātmanah
||

21. Āseeno dooram vrajati
Śayano yaṭi sarvataḥ |
Kas tam madāmadam devam
Mad anyo jñātum arhasi ||

Which is neither the cause nor the effect?
Which is neither the past nor the future?

15. Yama said: That is Om,
Of which goal the Vedas speak of,
For which goal men perform penance,
Desiring which men observe continence.
About that I shall speak briefly.

16. That syllable indeed is Brahman,
That syllable is the Supreme,
Whoever knows that syllable
Attains all that he desires.

17. That is the best support,
That is the supreme support,
Whoever knows that support
Is adored in the world of Brahmaa.

18. The Self is unborn
and undecaying at any time,
He springs from none
and nothing springs from Him;
He is ancient, unborn, eternal,
everlasting,
And not killed when the body is
destroyed.

19. If the killer thinks that he kills,
If the killed thinks that he is killed,
Neither of these two know the truth,
For the Self neither kills nor is killed.

20. Smaller than the smallest
and greater than the greatest,
The Self dwells in the hearts of all
beings,
The man of no action, freed from sorrow
Being tranquil in his mind and senses,
beholds the Self, the Majestic Lord.

21. Though sitting still He travels far,
Though lying down He is everywhere,
Who but myself can know that God,
Who rejoices and rejoices not.

22. Aṣareeramn ṣareereshu
Anavastheshv avasthitam |
Mahāntamn Vibhum ātmānamn
Matvā dheero no śochati ||

23. Nāyam ātmā pravachanena labhyo
Na medhaya na bahoonā śrutena |
Yam evaisha vṛṇute tena labhyas
Tasyaisha ātmā vivṛṇute tanoomn
svām ||

24. Nāvirato duṣcharitān
Nāśānto nāsamāhitah |
Nāśānta mānaso vāpi
Prajñānenainam āpnuyāt ||

25. Yasya Brahma cha kshatramn cha
Ubhe bhavata odanah |
Mptyur yasyopasechanamn
Ka ittha veda śotra sah ||

22. Bodiless is He among the bodies,
Permanent is He among
the impermanent,
Seeing the Great Self, the Omnipresent,
The wise grieve no more.

23. The Self is not revealed
by Scriptures,
Nor by intellect, nor by much learning,
He is gained by him, whom He chooses,
To him, He reveals his true nature.

24. Not until one desists from evil,
Not until one subdues his senses,
Not until one becomes serene in his
mind,
Can he comprehend the Self by
his awareness.

25. To whom both the knowledge and
the strength become food,
To whom death itself is a condiment,
To that man is the truth known,
Where the Self really is.

Tp̥teeyā Vallee

1. Rtamn pibantow sukṛtasya loke
guhāmn
Pravishtow parame parārdhe |
Çhaya tapow Brahnavido vadanti
Pañchāgnayo ye cha triṇāchiketāh ||

2. Yah setur eejānānam
Aksharamn Brahma yat param |
Abhayamn titeershatāmn pāramn
Nāchiketamn śakemahi ||

3. Ātmānamn rathinamn viddhi
Ṣareeramn ratham eva tu |
Buddhis tu sārādhimn viddhi

The Third Branch

1. Two selves, lodged in the secret cave,
the supreme seat,
Drink the essence of action in the world
of good deeds;
The knowers of Brahman, as also those,
Who maintain the five fires, and those
Who light up the triple Nāchiketa fire,
Describe them as light and shade.

2. May we seek that Nāchiketa fire,
The bridge for the sacrificers
And the Imperishable Brahman,
For those who wish to cross over to the
fearless shore.

3. Know the Self as the rider,
And the body as the chariot,
Know the intellect as the charioteer,

Manah pragraham eva cha ||

4. Indriyāṇi hayān āhur
Vishayāns teshu gocharān |
Ātmendriya mano yuktam
Bhoktety-āhur maneeshiṇah ||

5. Yas tv-avijñānavān bhavati
Yuktena manasā sadā |
Tasyendriyāṇy-avaśyāni
Dushtaśva iva sārathēh ||

6. Yas tu vijñānavān bhavati
Yuktena manasā sadā |
Tasyendriyāṇi vaśyāni
Sadaśva iva sārathēh ||

7. Yas tv-avijñānavān bhavati
Amanaskah sadā śuchih |
Na sa tat padam āpnoti
Samsāramn chādhipagacchati ||

8. Yas tu vijñānavān bhavati
Samanaskah sadā śuchih |
Sa tu tat padam āpnoti
Yasmāt bhooyo na jāyate ||

9. Vijñāna sārathir yas tu
Manah pragrahavān narah |
So'dhvanah param āpnoti
Tad Vishṇoh paramam padam ||

10. Indriyebhyah parā hy-artha
Arthebhyaś cha param manah |
Manasaś cha parā buddhir
Buddher ātmā mahān parah ||

11. Mahatah param avyaktam
Avyaktat purushah parah |
Purushān na param kiñchit
Sā kashtha sā parā gatih ||

And the mind as the reins.

4. The senses, they say, are the horses,
The objects they seek are the roads,
The Self, they say, is the enjoyer,
Linked with the body, mind, and senses.

5. When a man is fickle-minded,
Without the right intellect,
Uncontrollable are his senses,
Like unruly horses of a charioteer.

6. If a man has right understanding,
And his mind is steady,
Then his senses remain under his control
Like good horses of a charioteer.

7. When a man lacks proper
understanding,
His mind remains ever impure,
He never reaches the goal
And he returns back to birth.

8. But when a man has
proper understanding,
His mind becomes pure and serene,
He reaches his goal
And never returns back.

9. When pure intellect is the charioteer,
And pure mind is the reins,
He reaches that goal,
Which is all-pervading and everlasting.

10. The sensations are greater
than the senses,
The mind is greater than the sensations,
The intellect is greater than the mind,
Greater than the intellect is the great self.

11. Greater than the great self is the
Unmanifest,
Greater than the Unmanifest is the
Person,
There is nothing greater than the Person,

12. Esha sarveshu bhooteshu
Gooḍho'tma na prakāṣate |
Dpśyate tvagryaya buddhya
Sookshmayā sookshma darśibhih ||

13. Yacched vañ manasee prajñas
Tad yacchej jñāna ātmani |
Jñānam ātmani mahati niyacched
Tad yacchech chātma ātmani ||

14. Uttisthata jāgrata
Prāpya varān nibhodata |
Kshurasya dhārā niṣīta duratyaya
Durgam pathas tat kavayo vadanti ||

15. Aśabdam asparśyam aroopam
avyayamn
Tathā arasamn nityam agandhavach
cha yat |
Anādy-anantamn mahatah paramn
dhruvam
Nichāyya tamn Mptyu mukhāt
pramuchyate ||

16. Nachiketam upākhyānamn
Mptyu proktamn sanātanam |
Uktvā śrutvā cha medhāvee
Brahma loka maheeyate ||

17. Ya imamn paramamn guhyamn
Śrāvayed Brahma samnsadi |
Prayatah śraddha kāle va
Tad ānantyāya kalpate ||
Tad ānantyāya kalpate ||

Chaturthee Vallee

1. Parāñchi khāni vyatṇat

That is the summit, and that is the
Supreme Goal.

12. The Supreme Self,
hiding in the hearts of all beings,
Is not revealed to all,
But seen only by those keen on intellect
And single-pointed in vision.

13. The wise should place
the speech in the mind,
The mind in the intelligent Self,
The intelligent self in the great self,
And the great self in the Tranquil Self.

14. Arise! Awake! Understand!
Having obtained the boons.
Narrow is the path, so the seers say,
Narrower than the edge of a razor,
Difficult indeed is it to cross over.

15. Without sound, without form,
Without touch, without smell,
and without taste,
Without beginning and without end,
Greater than the manifest
and the Unmanifest,
Is the Imperishable Self fixed in eternity.
Realizing Him, a man is freed
from the jaws of death.

16. A wise man who tells or hears
The ancient story of Nachiketa
as told by Yama,
Attains greatness in the world of
Brahmaa.

17. Whoever recites this story in an
assembly of scholars,
Or devoutly at the funeral service,
Prepares himself for life in eternity,
Prepares himself for life in eternity.

The Fourth Branch

1. The Self-existent made the senses

svayambhoos

Tasmāt parān paśyati nāntarātmān |
Kaś chid dheeraḥ pratyag ātmānam
aikśhaḍ
Āvṛtta chakṣur amṛtatvam icchan ||

2. Parācha kāmān anuyanti bālāḥ
Te mptyor yanti vitatasya pāśam |
Atha dheerā amṛtatvam viditvā
Dhruvam adhruveshv-īha na
prārthayante ||

3. Yena roopam rasam gandham
śabdān sparśāṅś cha maithunam |
Etenaiva vijānāti kim atra
Pariśishyate etad vai tat ||

4. Svapnāntam jagarītāntam
Chobow ye nānupaśyati |
Mahāntam vibhum ātmānam
Matvā dheero na śochati ||

5. Ya imam madhvadam veda
Ātmānam jeevam antikāt |
Eśānam bhoṭa bhavyasya
Na tato vijugupsate ||
Etad vai tat ||

6. Yah poorvam tapaso jātam
Adbhyah poorvam ajāyata |
Guhāmn praviśya tishṭhantam
Yo bhootebhir vyapaśyata ||
Etad vai tat ||

7. Yā prāṇena sambhavaty-
Aditi devatāmāyee |
Guhāmn praviśya tishṭhanti
Ya bhootebhir vyajāyata ||
Etad vai tat ||

8. Araṇyor nihito jātavedā

go outward

And not to within where the Self exists;
Wishing for life in eternity,
Some wise men, however, looked inside,
And saw the Self within.

2. The ignorant crave for
outward pleasures,
And fall into the snare
of the widespread death;
The wise ignore the transient
And seek life in eternity.

3. By Whom a man sees, tastes, and
smells,
By Whom a man hears, touches, and
enjoys,
By Whom a man knows and thinks,
That indeed is the Supreme Self.

4. Knowing the Great Lord, The Self,
By Whom are experienced
Both the waking and the dream states,
The wise grieve no more.

5. Whoever knows the individual self,
The eater of the fruit of action,
As the Supreme Self,
The Lord of the past and future,
Goes beyond fear,
For he is verily That.

6. He, Who was born first of meditation,
Even before the water was born,
Enters every heart and lives
among the elements,
He is verily That.

7. She, Who arises with vital force,
Aditi, the mother of all gods,
Enters every heart and lives
among the elements,
This is verily That.

8. This Agni, the omniscient,
Hidden in the fire-sticks like

Garbha iva subhpto garbhīṇeebhiḥ |
Dive diva eēḍyo jagpvaḍbhir
Haviṣmadbhir manuṣhyebhir agnih ||
Etaḍ vai tat ||

9. Yataś chodeti sooryo
Astamn yatra cha gaḇḇhati |
Tamn devāḥ sarve'ṛpitāṣ
Tad u natyeti kaś chana ||
Etaḍ vai tat ||

10. Yad eveha tad amutra
Yad amutra tad anviha |
Mptyoh sa mptyum āpnoti
Ya iha nāneva paśyati ||

11. Manasaivedam āptavyam
Neha nānāsti kiñ chana |
Mptyoh sa mptyum gaḇḇhati
Ya iha nāneva paśyati ||

12. Anguṣṭha mōtrah puruṣho
Madhya ātmani tiṣṭhati |
Eeṣāno bhoota bhavyasya
Na tato vijugupsate ||
Etaḍ vai tat ||

13. Anguṣṭha mōtrah puruṣho
Jyotir ivādhoomakah |
Eeṣāno bhoota bhavyasya
Sa evāḍya sa u viśvah ||
Etaḍ vai tat ||

14. Yathodakamn durge vpshtamn
Parvateshu vidhāvati |
Evamn dharmān pṛthak paśyans
Tan evānuvidhāvati ||

15. Yathodakamn śuddhe śuddham
Āśiktam tadḍg eva bhavati |

a child in the womb,
Worshipped by men day after day
with oblations,
This is verily That.

9. That from Whom the Sun rises,
That into Whom the Sun sets,
That, Who is the source of all gods,
And That no one can transcend
This verily is That.

10. What is here is also yonder,
What is yonder is also here,
Whoever sees any difference here,
Goes even so from death to death.

11. By mind alone is this to be grasped,
That there is no plurality here,
For whoever sees any plurality here,
Goes even so from death to death.

12. Of the size of a thumb,
The Person dwells
in the middle of the body;
Knowing Him as the Lord
of the past and future,
A person goes beyond sorrow.
This is verily That.

13. Like a smokeless fire,
Of the size of a thumb,
Lord of the past and future,
Is the Person in the middle of the body.
He is the same today
and the same tomorrow.
He is verily That.

14. Just as the rain falling on a
mountains,
Streams down in various directions,
So also does a person runs
hither and thither,
Who sees only the multiplicity.

15. As pure water poured into pure water
Remains one and the same, O Gowtama,

Evamn muner vijānata
Ātmā bhavati Gowtama ||

Pañchamee Vallee

1. Puram ekādaśa dvāram
Ajasyāvakra chetasah |
Anushthāya na śochati
Vimuktaś cha vimuchyate ||
Etad vai tat ||
2. Hamnsah śuchishad vasur
antarikshasadd
Hotā vedishad atithir duroṇasat |
Nṛshat varasat ptasat vyomasad
Abjā gojā ptajā adriajā ptamn bṛhat ||
3. Oordhvam prāṇam unnayaty-
Apānam pratyag asyati |
Madhye Vāmanam āseenam
Viśve devā upāsate ||
4. Asya visramn samānasya
Śareerasthasya dehinah |
Dehād vimuñcha-mānasya
Kim atra pariśishyate ||
Etad vai tat ||
5. Na prāṇena nāpānena
Martyo jeevati kaś chana |
Itareṇa tu jeevanti
Yasminn etāv upāśritow ||
6. Hanta ta idam pravakshāmi
Guhyamn Brahma sanātanam |
Yathā cha maraṇamn prāpya
Ātmā bhavati Gowtama ||
7. Yonim anye prapadyante
Śareeratvāya dehinah |

So also this individual self on knowing
Unites with the Supreme Self.

The Fifth Branch

1. There lies a city of eleven gates,
Shining in the light of undistracted
consciousness,
Whoever rules that city
Is freed forever and grieves no more.
2. He is the swan dwelling in the sky,
He is the air in the atmosphere,
He is the sacrificer near the altar,
He is the guest at the sacrifice
Dwelling in men, gods, sacrifices, and
sky,
Born from water, earth, sacrifices,
and mountains,
He is the Truth, he is the Great.
3. The Dwarf sitting in the middle,
Shoots the vital breath up,
And the foul breath down;
All the gods adore Him.
4. What is there to remain
When the indweller, the inner self,
Withdraws himself from the body
And leaves the body?
He is verily That.
5. Neither by the inward breath,
Nor by the outward breath,
Does any mortal live;
But by another do they live
On which these two depend.
6. O Gowtama, I shall now teach you
The mystery of this Ancient Brahman
And also what happens to the soul
After it leaves the mortal frame.
7. Based on their thoughts and actions,
Some souls enter into wombs

Sthāṇum anye anusamyanti
Yathā karma yathā śrutam ||

In order to get new bodies;
Others are absorbed by matter.

8. Ya esha supteshu jāgarti kāmam
kāmam Purusho nirmimāṇah |
Tad śukram tad Brahma tad evamptam
uchyate |
Tasmin lokāḥ śrita sarve
tad u nṛtyeti kaś chana ||
E tad vai tat ||

8. That Person,
Who is awake during sleep,
Shaping desire after desire,
Is Brahman, the Pure and Eternal.
All the worlds dwell in Him
And no one ever transcends Him.
This verily is That.

9. Agnir yathaiko bhuvanamn pravishṭo
Roopamn roopamn pratiroomamn
babhoova |
Ekas tathā sarva bhootāntarātmā
Roopamn roopamn pratiroomo
bahiś cha ||

9. As the one fire takes on
Various forms in which it dwells,
So also does the One Self takes on
Various forms in which He dwells
And also exists outside them all.

10. Vāyur yathaiko bhuvanamn
pravishṭo
Roopamn roopamn pratiroomamn
babhoova |
Ekas tathā sarva bhootāntarātmā
Roopam roopam pratiroomo bahiś cha ||

10. As the one air takes on
Various forms in which it dwells,
So also does the One Self takes on
Various forms in which He dwells
And also exists outside them all.

11. Sooryo yathā sarva lokasya chakshur
Na lipyate chakshushair bāhya dośhāih |
Ekas tathā sarva bhootāntarātmā
Na lipyate loka duhkkena bāhyah ||

11. As the Sun, the eye of the whole
world,
Is not defiled by the external impurities,
That are seen here,
Even so, the One Self within all beings,
Is not touched by the misery of the
world,
For He exists outside them all.

12. Eko vāsi sarva bhootāntarātmā
Ekamn beejamn bahudhāyah karoti |
Tam ātmastham
ye'nupaśyanti dheereas
Teshāmn sukhamn śāśvatam
netareshāmn ||

12. That One Controller within all
beings
Makes His one form manifold;
Seeing Him in their own selves,
The wise taste the everlasting bliss.
Not others.

13. Nityo nityānāmn chetanaś
chetanāmn
Eko bahoonāmn yo vidadhaiti kāmān |

13. The Eternal among the Eternals,
The conscious among the conscious,
The One among the many,
Who grants desires,

Tam atmastham
ye'nupaśyanti dheerās
Tesham śāntih śaśvatee netaresham ||

14. Tad etad iti manyante'
Nirdeśyamn paramamn sukham |
Kathamn nu tad vijāneeyam |
Kim u bhāti vibhāti vā ||

15. Na tatra sooryo bhāti na chandra
tarakamn
Nemā vidyuto bhānti kuto'yam agnih |
Tam eva bhāntam anubhāti sarvamn
Tasya bhāsa sarvam idamn vibhāti ||

Shashthee Vallee

1. Oordhva moolo'vāk śākha
Esho'svatthah sanātanah |
Tad eva śukramn tad Brahma
Tad evāṃptam uchyate ||
Tasminl lokāśritah sarve,
Tad u nātyeti kaśchana ||
Etad vai tat ||

2. Yad idamn kiñcha jagat sarvamn
Prāṇa ejati nihsptam |
Mahad bhayamn vajram udyatam
Etad vidur amptās te bhavanti ||

3. Bhayād asyāgnis tapati
Bhayāt tapati sooryah |
Bhayād Indraś cha vāyuś cha
Mptyur dhāvati pañchamah ||

4. Iha ched aśakamn boddhumn
Prāk śareerasya visrasah |
Tatah sargeshu lokeshu
Śareeratvāya kalpate ||

Seeing Him in their own selves,
The wise taste the everlasting peace.
Not others.

14. Nachiketa said:
They describe That Indescribable
Supreme Bliss as This is That.
How then can I understand It?
Does It shine by Itself or by another
light?

15. Yama said:
There the Sun does not shine,
Nor the Moon, nor the stars,
Nor the lightnings flash,
Where will be this fire then?
When He shines all this shine,
And by His light alone all this is lighted.

The Sixth Branch

1. With the root above
and branches below,
The ancient Aśvattha tree is pure and
eternal. It is Brahman.
All worlds are within It.
No one ever transcends It.
It is verily That.

2. Whatever that is here
Issues forth and moves in the vital force;
Frightening indeed is the vital force,
Like an uplifted thunderbolt;
They, who know That, become immortal.

3. From fear of him the fire burns,
From fear of him the Sun shines,
From fear of him does Indra and Vāyu
And Death as the fifth run away.

4. If a man fails to know him here,
Before the body falls apart,
Such a man is destined to take a form,
In the world of creation.

5. Yathādarśe tathātmani
Yathā svapne tathā pitṛ loke |
Yathāpsu pareeva dadṛṣe
Tathā gandharva loke
Çhaya tapayor iva Brahma loke ||

6. Indriyāṇāmn pṛthag bhavam
Udayastamayow cha yat |
Pṛthag utpadyamānāmn
Matva dheero na śochati ||

7. Indriyebhyah paramn mano
Manasah sattvam uttamam |
Sattvaḍ adhi mahān ātmā
Mahato'vyaktam uttamam ||

8. Avyaktat tu para purusho
Vyāpako'linga eva cha |
Yam jñātvā muchyate jantur
Amptatvañ cha gacçhati ||

9. Na sandṛṣe tishṭhati roopam asya
Na chakshushā paśyati kaś chanainam |
Hṛdā maneeshā manasābhikl'pto
Ya etad vidur amptas te bhavanti ||

10. Yadā pañchavat tishṭhante
Jñānāni manasā saha |
Buddhiś cha na vicheshṭati
Tām āhuh paramāmn gatim ||

11. Tāmn yogam iti manyante
Sthirām indriya dhāraṇām |
Apramattas tadā bhavati
Yogo hi prabhavāpyayow ||

12. Naiva vācha na manasā

5. As in a dream
so in the world of the manes,
As in water so in the world of the spirits,
As in diffused light
so in the world of Brahman,
But in the self, the self is seen as in a
mirror.

6. The rising and setting of the senses,
Depends not on the Self,
But on the body,
Whoever knows this grieves no more.

7. The mind is greater than the senses,
Greater than the mind is the intellect,
Greater than the intellect is
the great self,
Greater than the great self is the
Unmanifest.

8. Greater than the Unmanifest is the
person,
All-pervading and without any mark
whatever,
It is by knowing Him that a man
attains freedom and immortality.

9. No eye can see Him,
Nor has He a form that can be seen,
Yet those who perceive Him
By the heart, the intellect,
and the mind, become immortal.

10. When the mind is resting
Undisturbed by the five senses,
When the intellect is steady,
A man, they say, reaches the highest
goal.

11. The firm control of the senses
Is what is called Yoga,
Undistracted is the mind in such a state,
When it witnesses neither gain nor loss.

12. He is not attained by the speech,

Prāptumn śakyo na chakshushā |
Asteeti bhruvato'nyatra
Kathamn tad upalabhyate ||

13. Asteety-evopalabdavyas
Tattva bhāvena chobayoh |
Asteety-evopalabdhasyas
Tattva bhāva praseedati ||

14. Yada sarve pramuchyante
Kāmā ye'sya hṛdi śritāḥ |
Atha martyo'mpto bhavaty-
Atra Brahma samaśnute ||

15. Yada sarve prabhidante
Hṛdayesha granthayah |
Atha martyo'mpto bhavaty-
Etvad anuśāsanam ||

16. Śatañ chaikā cha hṛdayasya nāḍyas
Tasāmn moordhānam abhinissptaikā |
Tayordhvam āyann amptatvam eti
Viśvann anyā utkrāmaṇe bhavanti ||

17. Anguśṭha mātṛah puruso'ntarātmā
Sada janānāmn hṛdaye sannivisṭah |
Tvam svach ḥhareṇat pravṛṇen
muñjād ivesheekāmn dhairyēṇa |
Tamn vidyāḥ ḥhukram amptam
Tamn vidyāḥ ḥhukram amptam ||
iti ||

18. Mptyu proktamn Nāchiketo'tha
labdhvā
Vidyāmn etāmn yoga vidhiñ cha kṛtsnam
|
Brahma prāpto virajo'bhood vimptyur
Anyopy-evam yo vid adhyātmam eva ||

Saha nāv avatu |
Saha now bhunaktu |
Saha veryam karavāvahai |

Nor by the mind nor by the eye,
How then can he be comprehended
Without one saying, "He is" ?

13. One must comprehend His existence
In both the seen and the unseen,
When He is apprehended as the existent,
His real nature shines forth.

14. When a man is freed from all
the desires that rest in his heart,
Then a mortal becomes immortal,
Right here in this body itself.

15. When all the knots of ignorance
Of the heart are severed,
A mortal becomes immortal,
Thus the teaching ends here.

16. A hundred and one pathways
Arise from the heart,
One among them goes to the crown,
And going upward through that
One becomes immortal,
The others are for other ends.

17. Of the size of a thumb,
The person, the inner self,
Dwells in the hearts of all,
He should be drawn out with steadiness
As pith from a reed,
Know that the Self is bright and
immortal,
Yea, He is bright and immortal.

18. Thus Nachiketa,
Having obtained this knowledge,
And all the rules of yoga,
As declared by Yama,
Has become free from desire and death,
And so shall those,
Who seek this knowledge of the Self.

May he protect us both,
May he guide us both,
May we both strive hard,

Tejasvināvadheetam astu |
Mā vidvishāvahi ||

Omn śāntih śāntih śāntih



May our study be invigorating,
May we never hate each other.

Omn Peace Peace Peace



